•	Colonel	Group Caption	Caption
•	Lt. Colonel	Wing Commander	Commander
•	Major	Squadron Leader	Lt. Commander (Hence pair 3 is correct matched)
•	Caption	Flight Lieutenant	Lieutenant
•	Lieutenant Colonel	Flying Officer	Sub-Lieutenant (Hence pair 4 is incorrect matched)

40. The North Eastern Council (NEC) was established by the North Eastern Council Act, 1971. Subsequent to the amendment of NEC Act in 2002, the Council comprises which of the following members?
1. Governor of the Constituent State.
2. Chief Minister of the Constitution State.
3. Three Members to be nominated by the President of India.
4. The Home Minister of India.
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans.(a): According to the North Eastern Council (Amendment) Act-2002.
- NEC members include the Governors and chief Ministers of 8 states, including Sikkim.
- And 3 member nominated by the President.
- The President shall nominate the chairman of the council.

41. Consider the following statements:
Statement-I : If the United States of America (USA) were to default on its debt, holders of US Treasury Bonds will not be able to exercise their claims to receive payment.
Statement-II : The USA Government debt is not backed by any hard assets, but only by the faith of the Government.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

Ans.(d):
- If the USA were to default on its debt, holders of US Treasury bonds would still have the legal right to exercise their claims to receive payment.
- The U.S. Govt. debt including Treasury bonds, bill and notes is not backed by any specific hard assets. Instead it is backed by the 'Full faith, and credit' of the U.S. Government.

Hence, statement I is not correct and statement II is correct.

42. Consider the following statements:
Statement-I : Syndicated lendings spreads the risk of borrower default across spreads the risk of borrwer default across multiple lenders.
Statement-II : The syndicated loan can be a fixed amount/lump sum of funds, but cannot be a credit line.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II in incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

Ans.(c): Syndicated lending involves a group of lenders collectively providing funds to a borrower. This approach helps in spreading the risk associated with borrower default across multiple lenders rather than having a single lender bear the entire risk. Hence statement-I is correct.
A syndicated loan can indeed be structured as either a fixed amount (a lump sum) or as a credit line (revolving credit facility). In a revolving credit facility the borrower can access funds upto a specified limit repay the borrowed amount and than borrow again up to the limit during the term of the facility. This flexibility is one of the key features of syndicated loans. Hence statement-II is correct.

43. Consider the following statements in respect of the digital rupee:
1. It is a sovereign currency issued by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) in alignment with its monetary policy.
2. It appears as a liability on the RBI's balance sheet.
3. It is insured against inflation by its very design.
4. It is freely convertible against commercial bank money and cash.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2 and 4

Ans.(d): The Central Bank Digital currency (CBDC) or **Digital Rupee (or ₹)** is a digital variant of physical currency issued by the Reserve Bank of India.
- **The CBDS (or Digital Rupee)** is a sovereign currency issued by RBI in accordance with their monetary policy.
- It is freely convertible against commercial bank money and cash.
- When bank customers convert their deposits into digital rupee, the RBI will have to take these liabilities from the books of banks and onto its own balance sheet.

44. With reference to ancient India, Gautama Buddha was generally known by which of the following epithets?
1. Nayaputta 2. Shakyamuni
3. Tathagata
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3
(d) None of the above are epithets of Gautama Budha

Ans.(b): Shakyamuni- This epithet means "Sage of shakyas" and is commonly used to refer to Gautama Buddha, highlighting his origin from 'Shakya Clan'.
- Tathagat- This term used by Gautama Buddha to refer to himself or other Buddhas, means one who has this gone" or "one who has thus come".
- Nayaputta- This epithet used for Mahavira, the 24th Tirthankara of Jainism.

45. Consider the following information:

	Archaeological Site	State	Description
1.	Chandraketugarh	Odisha	Trading Port town
2.	Inamgaon	Maharashtra	Chalocolithic
3.	Mangadu	Kerala	Megalithic
4.	Salihundam	Andhra Pradesh	Rock-cut cave shrines

In which of the above rows is the given information correctly matched?
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 2

Ans.(b): The correct match is as follows–

Archaeological Site	State	Description
Chandraketugarh	West Bengal	Trading Port Town
Inamgaon	Maharashtra	Chalcolithic site
Mangadu	Kerala	Megalithic site
Salihundam	Andhra Pradesh	Buddhist stupas and monastic complexes

46. Who of the following rulers of medieval India gave permission to the Portuguese to build a fort at Bhatkal?
(a) Krishnadevaraya (b) Narasimha Saluva
(c) Muhammad Shah III (d) Yusuf Adil Shah

Ans.(a):
- Krishnadevaraya signed a treaty with the Portugese in 1510, it permitted Albuquerque to construct fort at Bhatkal.
- Domingo Paes and Barbosa, Portugese travelers visited in Krishnadevaraya's court in 1520.
- He also helped the Portugese to conquer Goa from Bijapur in 1510.
- Bhatkal fort located at Uttara Kannada district in Karnataka.

47. With reference to revenue collection by Cornwallis, consider the following statements:
1. Under the Ryotwari Settlement of revenue collection, the peasants were exempted from revenue payment in case of bad harvests or natural calamities.
2. Under the Permanent Settlement in Bengal, if the Zamindar failed to pay his revenues to the state, on or before the fixed date, he would be removed from his Zamindari.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans.(b):
- **Ryotwari Settlement-** This system was instituted by sir Thomas Munro in 1820.
- The rent in the Ryotwari System was paid directly by peasants to the government.
- In this system the tax rates were 50% in dryland and 60% in wetland.
- Peasants were not exempted from paying revenue even in crop failure or natural Clamities.
- **Permanent Settlement-** Under this settlement if Zamindar failed to pay the fixed revenue to the state by specified date, his land would be confiscated and auctioned off by the British authorities.

48. Consider the following statements:
1. There are no parables in Upanishads.
2. Upanishads were composed earlier than the Puranas.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans.(b): Upnishads are the texts contain conversations between teachers and students.
- Some Upanishads include tales (parables). Exampls– Chhandogya Upnishad tells story of wise beggar and Katopnishad tells story of antology of the two birds.
- Upanishads were composed over 1000-600 BC, and Puranas were composed over 300-1000 AD.

49. Consider the following statements:
1. India is a member of the International Grains Council.
2. A country needs to be a member of the International Grains Council for exporting or importing rice and wheat.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans.(c):
- The International Grains Council (IGC) was established in 1949 as the International Wheat Council and was renamed in 1995 under grains trade convention.
- Members are designated as importers or exporters based on their average trade in grains, rice, and oilseeds.
- India has been included in the category of exporting member in July (2003).
- India is a member of the International Grains council (IGC).
- As of April, 2020 its membership comprises 11 Producing members and 18 importing members.

50. Which one of the following was the latest inclusion in the Intangible Cultural Heritage List of UNESCO?
(a) Chhau Dance (b) Durga Puja
(c) Garba Dance (d) Kumbh Mela

Ans.(c):

Culture Name	Type	State/ Region	Added IN UNESCO
Chhau dance	Performing art	West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha	2010
Durga Puja	Festival	Kolkata	2021
Garba	Festival	Gujarat	2023
Kumbh Mela	Festival	Prayagraj, Haridwar, Nashik and Ujjain	2017

Note- Latest inclusion in the Intangible cultural Heritage List of UNESCO is Garba dance.

51. The total fertility rate in an economy is defined as:
(a) The number of children born per 1000 people in the population in a year.
(b) The number of children born to a couple in their lifetime in a given population.
(c) The birth rate minus death rate.
(d) The average number of live births a woman would have by the end of her child-bearing age.

Ans.(d): The Total fertility Rate (TFR) is the average number of live births a woman would have by the end of her child-bearing age (15-45 years).
- In India, the TFR has experienced as significant decline, from 6. or more in 1950s to 2.0 in 2021.
- TFR of about 2.1 children per woman is called Replacement-level fertility.
- TFR lower than 2.1 children per woman indicates that a generation is not producing enough children to replace itself, which leading to an outright reduction in population.

52. Consider the following statements:
1. In India, Non-Banking Financial Companies dealers access the Liquidity Adjustment Facility window of the Reserve Bank of India.
2. In India, Foreign Institutional Investors can hold the Government Securities (G-Secs).
3. In India, Stock Exchanges can offer separate trading platforms for debts.